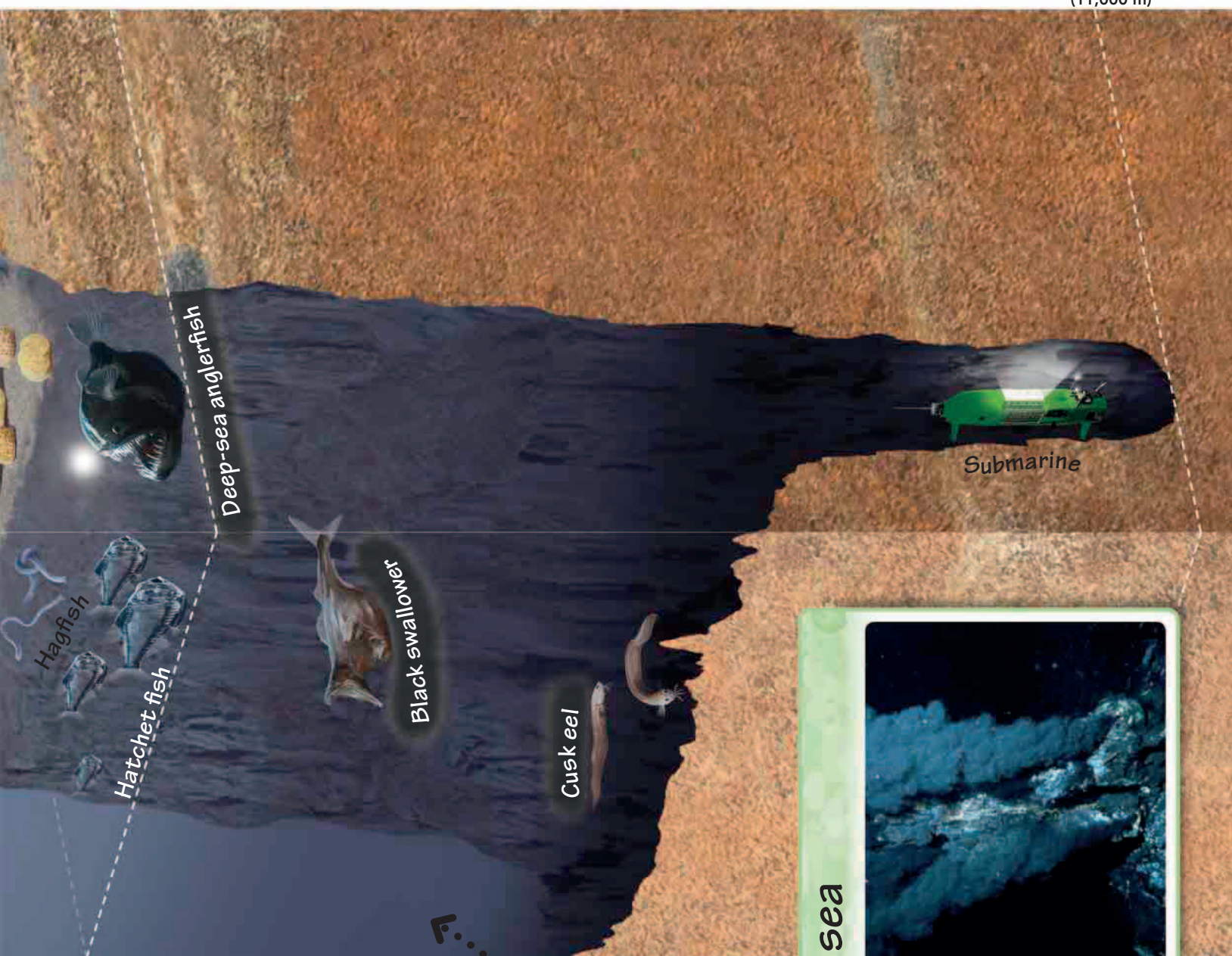


13,000 ft  
(4,000 m)

36,000 ft  
(11,000 m)



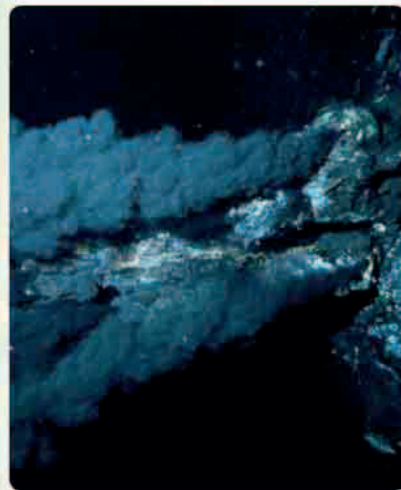
The cusk eel is the world's deepest living fish, surviving at 26,000 ft (8,000 m) below the surface.



## Deepest depths . . . . .

Little is known about the deepest, darkest areas of the ocean, which stretch down to almost 36,000 ft (11,000 m). These are zones that we are only just beginning to explore for signs of life.

## Chimneys under the sea



Water heated by hot rocks can spring out of the seabed through large cracks in the Earth's crust. Grains of minerals in the water make it look like smoke. The grains pile up and quickly harden into chimneylike towers up to 200 ft (60 m) high.